Project Report

VIT Bhopal University

VITyarthi E-Learning Platform

CSE0001 – Digital Literacy Project Assignment

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INTRODUCTION

The following is a report on my work for the CSE0001 Digital Literacy project at VIT Bhopal University. As part of this project, I have been allocated the role of a Student Digital Ambassador. This role requires a student digital ambassador to help students successfully navigate the digital world safely, responsibly, and professionally.

The project consists of five tasks, each of which corresponds to one of the modules of the course. The tasks include developing a digital literacy infographic, developing a professional online portfolio, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, practicing professional email communication, and conducting research on cybercrime awareness. All this work has been compiled into a single public GitHub repository that acts as my Digital Literacy Portfolio.

Through this project, I have learned that digital literacy is more than just knowing how to use a smartphone or access the internet. It involves thinking critically, communicating professionally, safely navigating the digital world, and constantly learning new digital skills. All these are important skills for a computer science student to have.

TASK 1 - DIGITAL LITERACY AWARENESS INFOGRAPHIC

For my Task 1 assignment, I created a one-page infographic using Canva, a free online graphic design tool that does not require prior knowledge of graphic design. The website offered various templates that I could use to create my infographic. I selected an infographic template in blue that looked modern and suitable for an academic context.

The infographic I created discusses five significant topics: what is digital literacy, digital tools that can help students, safe use of the internet, professional online image, and email etiquette. The infographic is created in such a way that it is easy to read and understand by incorporating various icons, titles, and bullet points.

I also used graphics and pictures on the infographic to make it eye catchy and develop interest in the reader. The goal was to create something that a fellow student could look at and immediately understand, without needing lengthy explanations.

One of the most challenging things I encountered in making my infographic was how to arrange my layout in such a way that all five topics were included in one page without making it appear messy. This is because there is limited space in an infographic. I learned how important it is to arrange my layout in such a way that it is easy to read. I found it interesting to learn how many free graphic design tools there are today that can assist me in making my infographic without requiring me to spend money.

TASK 2 — STUDENT DIGITAL PORTFOLIO

For the Task 2 assignment, I have created profiles on three different platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. These profiles are the foundation of the student digital portfolio.

- GitHub is the platform used by developers and students to share code and collaborate with other users. I have created a GitHub profile and created a special repository named after my username containing a README file in which I have written about myself with the details of my 'Name,' 'Branch,' 'Year,' 'Institution,' and 'Learning goals.' This 'README' repository serves as the personal landing page for anyone visiting the GitHub platform and reaching my GitHub profile.

- LinkedIn is the largest professional networking site in the world, and students, working professionals, and recruiters are using this platform. I have created my LinkedIn profile and filled in the 'Education' section with the details of the current degree pursued at VIT Bhopal University(Btech), the year of graduation(2029), and the branch of the course(CSE AI ML).

- Kaggle is the platform focused on data science and machine learning with the use of Kaggle kernels and the practice of data science and machine learning concepts. As I am pursuing CSE, this platform will be of great use to me.

In the next four years, I plan to use GitHub to share all of my projects, LinkedIn for professional networking and applying for internships and jobs, and Kaggle for learning data science and machine learning concepts through hands-on practice and competitions.

TASK 3 — CODING AND COLLABORATION PLATFORMS

For Task 3, I was required to examine two different coding platforms: a coding practice site and a cloud-based collaboration site. These two platforms represent two different types of platforms that can be used in an academic or professional environment.

- Part A of this task, I was required to create an account on HackerRank and complete the "Say Hello, World! With Python" problem, which is a beginner-level problem intended to get new users accustomed to HackerRank and basic coding in Python. This problem requires you to write a single line of code to print output. After completing this problem, I was able to submit it successfully and obtain a green tick. This was an easy problem; however, it allowed me to get accustomed to HackerRank's interface and gave me confidence to attempt other problems in the future.

- For Part B of this task, I was required to develop a five-question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms. The questions cover various topics such as strong password usage, two-factor authentication, cloud storage platforms, suspicious emails, and public Wi-Fi usage.

These platforms will definitely prove to be useful in an academic context. HackerRank will allow me to develop my coding skills and aid me in future coding assessments. Google Forms and Google Sheets will allow me to collect data and collaborate with my peers in future projects. Both of them collectively allow me to use my cognitive and technical skills.

TASK 4 — PROFESSIONAL EMAIL AND ETIQUETTE GUIDE

For Task 4, I composed two professional emails and developed a Social Media Do's and Don'ts checklist for college students.

- For the emails, I composed one to be sent to a professor requesting an extension on an assignment submission deadline and another to be sent to an internship coordinator expressing interest in a summer internship opportunity. I structured both emails according to professional email guidelines: clear and concise subject line, professional greeting, organized email body, and professional closing.
  From this task, I learned that professional communication is an aspect that needs to be developed and honed. The tone and language used in an email can greatly influence how the intended recipient perceives the sender. An email written in an unprofessional tone and language, despite having positive intent, can lead to negative impressions that are very hard to rectify.

- Social media has become an essential part of college life, making it important to use it responsibly. Understanding the Do's and Don'ts helps students protect their privacy, maintain a professional image, and avoid serious consequences. These guidelines teach us to think before we post, respect others online, and build a positive digital reputation that lasts a lifetime.
  A real-life example of poor digital communication that caused damage to an individual is when a student posted on social media impolite and disparaging comments about his professor without knowing that his post was viewable to everyone on social media, including his professor. This caused him to be issued a formal complaint and disciplinary action against him for his actions. This situation could have been avoided if he kept his personal grievances to himself and was professional in all his online activities at all times.

TASK 5 — CYBERCRIME AWARENESS CASE STUDY AND PREVENTION

In this task, I have attempted to provide a detailed case study on UPI payment scams, which are one of the most common cybercrimes affecting college students and young adults across India. In addition, I have provided a list of preventative measures that can be taken by people to stay safe.

The most surprising thing that I learned during my research on this topic was that when a user enters their UPI PIN to "accept" a transaction, this transaction will be sent instead of received. This single mistake has become the cause of many UPI scams across India. The fact that even educated people are becoming victims of these scams shows the importance of financial literacy.

Another surprising thing that I learned during my research was that these scammers are very clever and try to build trust by pretending to be Army officials or bank officials.

Another aspect that made me reflect personally was realizing that even an aware person can unknowingly click on suspicious links when they are in a hurry or not paying close attention. This reinforced for me that digital safety is not just about knowing the risks — it is about building consistent safe habits every single day. When a person is in haste or not cautious enough this can happen to them even after they know the consequences and are aware for the threats posed in the digital world. I used to do it first, now I have added security filters and two factor authentication for safety check.

One thing that I will change about myself after this task is that I will make sure not to enter my UPI PIN unless I have sent the transaction myself. In addition, I will make sure to verify the identity of the sender before sending any money. If any suspicious activity occurs, I will make sure to report this to cybercrime.gov.in or call the Cyber Crime Helpline on 1930.

CONCLUSION

This project gave me a clear and practical introduction to digital literacy. Through the five tasks, I learned how to build a professional online presence, communicate effectively in formal settings, use relevant coding and collaboration tools, and protect myself from online threats. Most importantly, I realized that digital literacy is not just one skill; it is a mix of awareness, responsibility, and ongoing learning. All of these are essential for succeeding as a computer science professional in today's digital world.

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